

Alicante → Máster

A 24-week Spanish course at Estudio Sampere, and how it reaches a Spanish public-university master's without a flight home. Prepared 4 September 2026.

THE ANSWER

Start Monday 31 January 2028

24 weeks · 20 classes/week · B2 earned in Alicante · master begins September 2028

The road

SEPTEMBER 2027

Begin collecting visa documents

Criminal record (bulletin n°3) → apostille at a Tunisian notary → sworn translation into Spanish. This chain is the longest lead time in the whole plan.

BY 30 NOVEMBER 2027

File the language-course visa in Tunis

Art. 36.1: file at least 2 months before the course starts. National visas go direct to the Embassy — emb.tunez.cit@maec.es — not through BLS, which handles Schengen short-stay only.

31 DECEMBER 2027

You may enter Spain

Art. 55.2 starts your permit one month before the course. Keep this buffer — it is free time and it protects the end of the plan.

31 JANUARY 2028

Course starts

You arrive at B1 (A1 and A2 done in Tunisia). 24 weeks × 20 classes.

26 MAY 2028

B2 reached — week 17 of 24

Instituto Cervantes counts B1 as 120 teaching hours and B2 as 180 — from a finished A2, ~333 Sampere classes.

16 JUNE 2028

SIELE certificate in hand

Sit it at Sampere — they are a DELE and SIELE centre. Results in ≤3 weeks. **DELE will not work here:** fixed sittings, ~2 months for results.

17-26 JUNE 2028

Apply to the master — Distrito Único Andaluz, Fase 2

One application covers every Andalusian public university, up to six choices. Your certificate arrives 10 days before the door shuts.

17 JULY 2028

Course ends

22 JULY 2028

Admission list published — your permit is still alive

This is the hinge of the entire plan. See page 2.

~24 JULY 2028

File the master's authorisation, from Spain

Form EX-00, fee €10.94, at the Oficina de Extranjería of the *master's* province — not Alicante.

1 AUGUST 2028

Language permit expires — and you stay legal anyway

Art. 54.3: “La solicitud de autorización prorrogará la situación legal de la persona solicitante hasta la resolución del procedimiento.”

16 AUGUST 2028

Master's permit takes effect

Fixed by art. 55.2 at one month before classes, whenever you filed.

15 SEPTEMBER 2028

Master begins

Why it has to be this way

Three constraints are fixed: **24 weeks** (budget), **no flight home**, and **B2 can only be earned in Spain** — because Tunisia covers A1 and A2 only.

A 24-week course buys roughly six months of legal stay. That stay has to do **two jobs**, and the jobs sit far apart in the year.

Job 1 — deliver the certificate

B2 arrives at week 17. Add three weeks for the exam result. **You cannot apply before week 21.**

Job 2 — still be alive at the handover

The master's permit switches on a month before classes. **Your permit must reach that date.**

Why not start in September 2027

An autumn start delivers the certificate in January, in time for **Fase 1** — the phase reserved for foreign-degree holders, with places held back and an admission list in February. It is the better door. But the course then ends in February and the permit dies in March, with the master seven months away.

course + permit

nothing — 6-month hole

Sept 2027 start · certificate lands early, permit dies long before the master

Nothing legal fills that hole on this budget. A *prórroga* exists, but art. 55.5 ties it to **a course you are enrolled in** — you cannot buy bare time, only more weeks you cannot afford. The alternative is flying home, which is ruled out.

Why not start later than January 2028

Push the start to mid-February and the certificate arrives on 30 June — **four days after the application window closes**. The year is then lost.

Why 31 January is the only position

course + permit → 1 Aug

bridge

master permit

31 Jan 2028 start · certificate 10 days early, permit alive when admission lands, gap closed by law

It is the single week where both ends reach: the certificate clears the June deadline with ten days to spare, *and* the permit survives to 1 August — past the 22 July admission list.

The fortnight between the permits closes itself

Your permit ends 1 August; the master's begins 16 August. Filing on 24 July extends your legal status **until the file is resolved**, and the offices run about four months behind — Madrid's official figures for 1 January 2026 show them working on applications filed the previous September. So you remain legal straight through, and the new permit is already in force from 16 August. Here the backlog works for you.

Dates for 2028 are projected from the published 2026/27 cycle. The governing Acuerdo publishes in BOJA around 20–23 December 2027 — verify then and shift the start Monday if the window moves.

The one weak joint

Art. 54.3 wants the master's application filed **two months before your current permit expires**. Your permit expires 1 August, so the rule points at 2 June. But Fase 2's admission list does not exist until 22 July.

You would be filing 50 days later than the rule asks

This is anticipated. The DGGM *Criterios Interpretativos* (7 August 2025) §1 list accepted justifications, and yours is among them — the institution's own admission calendar making earlier filing impossible — proven by an official certificate or published calendar. §19 extends the same reasoning to this exact deadline.

But it is an argued exception, not a right. Late filing is formally a ground for *inadmisión* under LOEx Disposición Adicional 4ª. If refused, a *recurso de reposición* within one month cures the defect, and is reported to succeed on precisely this point.

Three free things that reduce the risk

- **Attach a university certificate stating the official Fase 2 dates.** That specific document is what §1 asks for. A bare admission letter is weaker evidence.
- **Ask whether the university files under art. 54.6.** If it does, resolution takes 15 days instead of four months. RD 316/2026, in force 16 April 2026, opened this to any officially recognised Spanish university. No university advertises it — you have to ask.
- **Write to the Oficina de Extranjería of the master's province now** and ask how they treat a late filing justified by the DUA calendar. Get the answer before you commit money.

Details that cost or save real money

ITEM	WHAT TO DO
Visa buffers	Keep them. The month before the course is what lets you enter on 31 December and settle in. It pushes the permit past six months, so a TIE and an apostilled criminal record become due — unavoidable here, and needed for the switch anyway.
Insurance	Must cover the whole requested period, buffers included. A policy capped at six months makes the consulate silently cut days off your visa. No copays, no waiting periods, insurer registered with the DGSFP.
Proof of funds	€600/month (IPREM 2026, frozen for a fourth year) for the full stay. Tuition does not count toward it.
Acceptance letter	Ask Sampere to word it “20 horas lectivas semanales” , not “20 lessons”. Consulates print “horas lectivas” and some read it as clock hours.
Fee	€10.94 — tasa 790/052, line 1.1.1. Not €17.49; that is the <i>prórroga</i> line, and most guides still quote it.
Travel	Do not leave Spain between filing and collecting the new TIE. The <i>autorización de regreso</i> is drafted for renewals and does not clearly cover a new initial application.

Two things that are settled in your favour

Sampere Alicante is on the Instituto Cervantes accredited list (Avda. Óscar Esplá 4) — that is the hard legal requirement of art. 52.1.e).2º, and it is met. And **there is no “20 hours per week” rule**: the phrase appears nowhere in RD 1155/2024, nowhere in the old RD 557/2011, and not once in Instrucción SEM 3/2025. It is consular folklore. 20 classes of 45 minutes is fine.

What to do, and when

WHEN	ACTION
Now	Book a Spanish level assessment. The entire plan assumes you finish A2 in Tunisia and reach B2 in exactly 17 weeks. Test that assumption before anything else depends on it.
Now	Email Sampere: confirm a 24-week course starting 31 January 2028, and ask them to word the acceptance letter as “20 horas lectivas semanales, 480 horas lectivas”.
Now	Email emb.tunez.cit@maec.es : what weekly hours does the Tunis embassy expect, and do they accept a written waiver of the 45-day buffers? Tunis publishes no requirement sheet at all.
Autumn 2027	Order the <i>bulletin n°3</i> criminal record, apostille it (Tunisian notary, 10–20 TND), and have it sworn-translated into Spanish.
By 30 Nov 2027	File the visa.
Dec 2027	Check BOJA for the real 2028/29 Distrito Único calendar and adjust the start Monday if it moved.
Feb 2028	On arrival: <i>empadronamiento</i> , then the TIE within one month.
Apr 2028	Shortlist up to six masters in the DUA catalogue. Read each <i>ficha</i> — some ask C1, not B2. Book the SIELE sitting.
Jun-Jul 2028	Apply, then file the change of status the moment the admission list appears.

What this plan does not solve

Spain has **no official master's degree in music production, electronic music, or sound design** — the Ministry's register lists five official music master's nationally. Everything else sold under those names is *título propio*: not a degree. Spanish B2 opens acoustics engineering at about €821 a year in Andalucía, plus one twelve-place creative programme in Valencia with an unpublished entrance exam.

The best-fitting Spanish programme for a software-engineering graduate — **UPF Barcelona's Sound and Music Computing** — is taught in **English** and needs no Spanish at all. And every fully-funded route open to a Tunisian is English-taught: Fundación Carolina excludes Tunisia, AECID África-Med is civil-servants-only, Spanish university international scholarships are Ibero-American, and no scholarship anywhere funds a preparatory language year.

None of that makes this roadmap wrong. It makes it a plan you should choose deliberately rather than by default.

Confidence

Confirmed from primary sources: all article numbers and quoted text from RD 1155/2024 and Instrucción SEM 3/2025; the DGGM *Criterios Interpretativos* of 7 August 2025; the fee schedule in Orden PJC/617/2025; Sampere's Cervantes accreditation; Tunisia's apostille status; the published 2026/27 Distrito Único calendar; the Instituto Cervantes hours per level.

Projected: every 2028 date, patterned on the 2026/27 cycle.

Could not be established: the appointment queue in Tunis, real processing times for Tunisia, and how strictly any Extranjería office polices the two-month rule. No first-hand account of this exact transition under the new regime exists — the regime is only sixteen months old.

Sources: BOE-A-2024-24099 · Instrucción SEM 3/2025 · DGGM *Criterios Interpretativos* 07/08/2025 · Orden PJC/617/2025 · Distrito Único Andaluz · Instituto Cervantes · Embajada de España en Túnez · HCCH Apostille status table. Not legal advice; confirm with the consulate and the receiving Oficina de Extranjería before committing funds.